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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uckpkAmkm48
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-24. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:03:20] Hey Dan. Hello, how are you? Good, how are you? Good. We're not live, are we? We are live, yes. Okay, then I'll be quiet. Kevin and I went ahead and got it set up so that we're ready to go right

[00:03:40] at two. I'll wait for people to join in. Hi, Shelly. Emily, I'm having some trouble with my

[00:04:31] activity, so I called in on my phone. Can you hear me okay? Okay. Yes. Hey, Emily, just checking

[00:05:19] make sure you can hear me this is jen yep i can hear you thank you thank you i see we have dr wilson joined us uh michael is here jessica is here uh mrs davis vaught is here so just to let everybody know we are live on youtube and we're just going to wait a couple more minutes for folks to join and then i'll pull down the slides so that everybody can see each other um when dr paxton

[00:05:57] gets us started and for all of our presenters um if you have told me that you're going to run your slideshow you you do have um screen sharing rights once i pull down the slides afternoon

[00:06:31] hi dr lane good afternoon everybody hello hello still waiting on a couple more people to join

[00:06:46] hello dr man hi there just waiting on a couple more people to join um and we'll get started here

[00:07:52] you're in just a few minutes. Okay. Hi, Julie. Just waiting on a couple more people to join

[00:09:09] and we'll get started in just a few minutes. And for those that have just joined us, we are live on YouTube and I'll pull down our title slide here in just a minute or two once we get started

[00:09:21] so everybody can see each other. A couple more people to join. Dr. Pexton, can you hear me okay?

[00:10:25] Yes, ma'am. I can. All right. i'm going to go ahead and stop screen share so everybody can see each other and then we'll get

[00:10:35] started here in just a minute dr pexton it is two o'clock and i think we have everybody here

[00:11:27] um i'm trying i'm counting squares make sure we have everybody um but i think we've got everybody on maybe not everyone has their camera on just yet but we do have um everyone here so i'll go Go ahead and turn it over to you.

[00:11:44] - Awesome, great. Thank you, Emily, appreciate it. Good afternoon, everyone. As was echoed this morning in the board meeting, Happy New Year, I suppose, for the last time. But just wanna thank you for joining us today for a meeting of the special committee to review the standards of accreditation.

[00:12:02] Today's meeting is our first meeting of 2021, and it's going to be the first meeting following our work session that we had back in November. Before we dive into our meeting, want to thank both committee members staff and the public for their continued engagement in our work and i specifically want to give a shout out to emily because she has been on point keeping me on point to be on track and and well prepared for these meetings so so thank you to all and thank you to emily so during today's committee meeting we will receive three presentations from video vdoe staff based on our discussion from the november meeting the first will be an update on the college

[00:12:41] Career and Civic Readiness Index Indicator. The second will be an update on growth measures used in school accreditation calculations. And the third will be an update on the definition and supports for students with limited and/or interrupted formal education, otherwise known as SIFE and SLIFE. Over the next few months, just to give you a forward look as far as what's to come After today's meeting, staff will be bringing presentations and recommendations to the committee that correlate to our discussion topics and ultimately help us determine some next steps.

[00:13:21] We will continue to look at technical changes and corrections to the 2017 SOA revisions, possibly SOA compliance levers, specifically equity levers, and changes to the overall accreditation system and graduation requirements.

[00:13:38] While we do not have a set deadline to complete our work, I do anticipate that we will wrap up during the summer or early fall to make recommendations to the full board. So before we jump into our agenda for today, have committee members had a chance to review the minutes from the November 18th, 2020 community meeting for some virtual nods?

[00:14:04] All right. Can I get a motion to approve or amend the minutes? Motion to approve, Dr. Peckston. Thank you, Dr. Doran. Can I get a second? Second. - Thank you, Ms. Davis-Thault. We will do a roll call vote of the committee members.

[00:14:22] Again, Dr. Duran. - Aye. - Ms. Davis-Thault. - Aye. - Dr. Wilson. Did I miss that, Dr. Wilson? - Aye, I'm sorry, can you hear me?

[00:14:38] - Yes, thank you. And Chair votes aye. All right, so that motion passes for the approval of the minutes. So let's go ahead and jump into our first topic today. First on the agenda is going to be the update on the College Career and Civic Readiness Index Indicator.

[00:14:54] While this indicator was approved as part of the 2017 revisions, it will not become a factor in high school accreditation until the 2021-2022 school year. So our presenters today are Dr. Jennifer Pivirena, VDOE Director of Research, and Julie Malik, VDOE Director of Accountability.

[00:15:15] So ladies, I will turn it over to you. - Thank you, Dr. Pexton. We appreciate the opportunity to come before you today review and update you on the College Career and Civic Readiness indicator. My name is Julie Malik, as you mentioned, Director of Accountability, just so you know who is who, and Dr. Paiva-Rena will speak up here in just a little while. So just as an overview, we are just going to touch

[00:15:51] real quick on some items that we presented to you in June and July, and just touch on a reminder of the philosophy of accountability and the indicator criteria that was used at the time of the revision.

[00:16:08] We're also going to review the college career and civic readiness indicator in more detail and then we're going to dive into some available data and review the implementation timeline of it. So just as a reminder, the mechanisms of accountability, the purpose of accountability systems is to identify areas schools could improve to meet the priorities of the state and so this one is definitely fits that bill as far as the priorities when we selected

[00:16:45] accreditation indicators these were the criteria used at the time i'd like to focus on the second and third criteria to standardize data collection processes across schools and divisions and data the metric are reliable and valid. These are primarily the reasons why we did choose to delay the implementation of the college career and civic readiness indicator. We didn't feel like divisions in the state were quite where we needed to be for these two criteria. However,

[00:17:20] we wanted to make sure we included it along our path toward selecting our indicators and it would also forced some improvements to be made and i'll mention those in just a minute so as a reminder the college career and civic readiness indicator is comprised of four components um credit received for advanced coursework cte finisher with a cte credential a completion of a work-based learning experience and a completion of a service learning experience at the time there were some conversations

[00:17:58] about whether this should be participated in or received credit or how hey julie julie yes sorry to interrupt you is there any way you could get a little closer to the mic i think there's a couple folks that are possibly having some trouble hearing you or potentially breaking up it's quiet on my end but it's not breaking up but i just want to make sure everybody's getting all of your information sure and i will try to project a little bit better is that better thank you okay great thank you so um at the time there was a lot of discussion about if students should

[00:18:35] be proficient or complete or be successful or just 4 3 3 9 4 0 5 keep going okay i will um and it was determined that we needed to receive credits um for the advanced coursework and part of the cte finisher is to receive credit two credits in the sequence um under two or more standard credits for a state approved sequence in a cte program that's the definition of a cte finisher so it involves

[00:19:15] two credits um toward that sequence and then the completion of work-based learning experience and the completion of a service learning experience so why is the college career and civic

readiness indicator unique and helpful. It captures different pathways a student could pursue in getting there and completing public education.

[00:19:42] It focuses on the time that as Dr. Peckson mentioned where the students are leaving public education to ensure they've got an experience to help them after they leave public education. It captures work-based learning experiences which is new and also doesn't duplicate any other accountability indicators which typically focus which many of them focus on assessment results so just as a general rule i'm just going to repeat um basically dr pexton did a great job of this introducing um but it is based on the on-time graduation cohort

[00:20:22] rate which i'll go into a little bit more detail in a minute there's also been been some confusion there are four components but if a student only counts once in the measure even if they achieve all four components within their time in the high school but they still only count once in the numerator and again this is slated to be part of the accreditation ratings for the 22-23 accreditation year using data from the 2021-2022 cohort so what does that look like well this this graphic does a

[00:21:00] great job the first couple rows does a great job to kind of show you how that cohort spans many years and the opportunities given to the child that span many years so if we look at two cohorts of particular interest in the cohort of 2019 which was the first time we were able to create some data for divisions to look at this information but notice those students graduate or concluded their fourth year in high school after the 2018-2019 school year but if you'll look that means they

[00:21:37] started their four years in high school in the 2015-2016 school year so those students came into school in ninth grade in 2015-16 cccri wasn't even on anyone's radar at that time right until the revision and so the first complete year that we we're going to examine in a little while it's part of this cohort that the students started high school before the indicator was a known item and then the other cohort we're very interested in is the 2022 cohort because as

[00:22:15] i mentioned that is the first cohort whose data will be used in accreditation ratings in the 2022-2023 school accreditation year so we're interested in this cohort and if we know that means those students first entered high school as a ninth grader in the 2018-2019 school year. That's going to be important to think about. So what have we done over this time to improve the validity and reliability of this data and the data collection systems?

[00:22:50] And the big change was in 2017-2018 when these work-based learning experiences could be tagged to courses other than CTE courses. In the past, CTE's really been the focus of where those work-based learning experiences may have taken place and service learning experiences. So in 2017-18, that was the first year that those experiences could take place outside of the CTE courses.

[00:23:21] In 2018-2019, we added the Cambridge program as a means to earn that advanced coursework requirements or options in 2019-2020 there were some adjustments made to externship school-based enterprise internship or entrepreneurship sorry to include those in work-based learning experiences and then as early as this year a mentorship component was included but that mentorship

[00:23:58] had to include 140 contact hours so that was an adjustment. So let's look at some scenarios where students could track through these four years. Again at the top we have as we go from left to right we're indicating this is year one which is typically ninth grade but when they enter but they may transfer in which I'm going to talk about in a minute. Year two, year three, year four.

[00:24:30] We try to avoid freshman, sophomore, junior, and senior because students progress through these four years at different rates. So it's their first year, their second year, their third year, and their fourth year. And then there's a column to indicate if the student earned credit for the school for the CCCRI and the numerator, and if they are included in the denominator of the calculation.

[00:24:54] So we look at this first row. So we see the student enters high school in year one, doesn't collect any of these components until year four, where they become a CTE finisher with a CTE credential. Therefore, they're in the denominator, and they are part of the numerator as they earn credit.

[00:25:13] If we look at the second row, we'll see the student had a work-based learning experience in their first year. So that student is already an administrator of the CCCRI when they get to the end of their fourth year.

[00:25:32] So they have already collected that information, so when they progress, the schools know that they already have that experience, but look in year three, they also have a credit and dual enrollment course. So they've completed two pieces of the CCCRI, but they count once in the numerator and once in the denominator, and we determine that at the end of the fourth year.

[00:25:57] We don't look at them at the end of the first year. We follow this entire progression, and we evaluate at the end of the fourth year. We look at that third row. That student didn't receive any of these components for any of their four years, so they're still in the denominator, but they're not in the numerator.

[00:26:16] and it is important to note that transfer students impact the CCCRI. So in this fourth row, the student wasn't in the school in year one. They transferred in in year two and were assigned to this cohort.

[00:26:33] So the school has then provided them with an experience and they received credit in an AP course in year three. Therefore, at the end of year four, they count in the numerator and the denominator. And then the final row, this is a student who may have started with the school in year one, in year two, they were in the school, but they transfer out of state in year three.

[00:26:59] So they are not in the denominator and they are not part of the calculation. So what happens at this point? Well, at the end of that year four, for this group of students, now we're only looking at four students in this case. Of course, if we only had four students, we wouldn't calculate the rate truly, but we'll have hundreds of students perhaps in the cohort.

[00:27:24] cohort but in this case we have three students who met the components to be considered in the numerator we have four students in the denominator so this school's rate off of these four students would be 75 and just a quick reminder of where our level our benchmarks fall um 85 or more put schools in a level one between 71 and 84 give schools a level two and at 70 or lower they're

[00:27:56] at a level three so that is just a review just to set the basis kind of review the cohort rate review how and why this became an indicator and now i'm going to switch it the presentation over dr pivarenna to talk about some data great thank you julie uh so to provide some context to the discussion around the indicator we wanted to present you with the best available data that we have on the cccri in terms of where we are now so to do that we're going to focus on the 2019

[00:28:33] graduation cohort which is the most recent cohort for which the cccri was calculated given the waivers for accreditation for the 2020 accreditation cycle so these are students who graduated in 2019 a

little more than a year ago so a couple of things to keep in mind as we're looking at the data so for this cohort as julie showed in a previous slide this indicator is still relatively new for schools data collections were not fully available for all students in this cohort until they were in their third or junior year and we know that some school divisions

[00:29:10] had to make changes to their student records to be able to report the information that was required for this indicator to doe and it just takes time for those collections to mature and to provide reliable data. But based on what we know, for the 2019 accreditation cycle, among the 330 high schools that received an accreditation rating, 26% were at a level one performance rating on the CCCRI, 43% were at level two, and 30% were at level three. And again, an additional reminder that while we provide this information to school divisions, this isn't used at this point to

[00:29:50] determine accreditation rating. So it was really provided as information to schools to help them check and verify the data as this indicator matures throughout the process. Next slide, Julie. Thanks. So a little bit further breakdown into the cohort of 2019 in terms of the specific components of the CCCRI. So in the 2019 cohort, we have about 98,000 students. Among those 52,000

[00:30:27] or so met the criteria for advanced coursework so this is about 53 percent of our cohort and as you go down the the list here you can see the number of students and the percent of students that met each of the criteria cte completion work-based learning and then service learning now if a student earned more than one of these they would be counted in each of those numbers so if they had an advanced coursework and cte completion they're both reflected here but as a reminder that is not the final way in which we calculate the CCCRI.

[00:31:02] They're only counted once. And so if you look further down here, you'll see that we have the number of students that met at least one component of the CCCRI, and that was about 74,000 students, again, 75% of the cohort.

[00:31:19] But we do have a significant number of students as well that are meeting more than one criteria on this indicator, so about 36%. of the cohort met more two or at least two or more components for this indicator. Next slide Julie. We also wanted to spend a little time talking about the anticipated implementation of the CCCRI in terms of how it is framed now. So as Julie mentioned again, when we

[00:31:52] implemented the revised SOA, we stated that cohort 2022 would be the first cohort in which the CCCRI data would be factored into the accreditation rating. And that cohort is on far right of this slide. And we've just discussed the most recent data that we have available from cohort 2019 in terms of a full cohort. And so that is on the far left of the slide.

[00:32:18] So for cohort 19, we present the data by year so that you can see the distribution of students that are meeting the CCCRI for each year of the cohort from their second year, so essentially sophomores on into their senior year and the numbers that you see are the medians for each of these uh each of these indicators so i want to focus for a minute on cohort 19 and again this is imperfect data especially in this first year their sophomore year these students were sophomores in

[00:32:51] 2016-17 that was prior to the implementation of the revised soa so we obviously see a relatively low rate of achievement a median of 8.1 that's not a surprise that's a data completeness issue we didn't have school divisions fully reporting on these students until the following year so moving into their junior year or their third year of the cohort 2019 you see that students and data systems are making some ground

and we have a little more than half of students that are meeting the criteria in their third year and then at the conclusion of their fourth year

[00:33:28] those schools in the state have a median cccri of about 76 so we can use this to then compare those trends to the cohorts that followed after for the 2020 cohort we see a much clearer picture of how they're performing in their sophomore or their second year this would have been 2017-18 so our data systems now allow school divisions to fully report the information that we need on these students we also see that cohort 2020 has a slightly higher median in their third year

[00:34:03] their junior year so they're making some progress but our ability to see the data following this is limited because accreditation is waived and those indicators were not calculated so similarly for cohort 2021 we see they are achieving the cccri at similar rates to the previous cohort in their second year but their progress following that is unknown. So moving into cohort 2022 we have we don't have any information about the CCCRI in their sophomore or junior year

[00:34:37] their second or third year due to the waiver of accreditation and their fourth year their senior year which would be next year will be the first year their rate is calculated for this cohort and the first year it is used in accreditation and that puts us in a tough position for helping school divisions understand the trajectory of their students performance on this particular indicator next slide julie and so not that you need a reminder but just taking a moment to sort of

[00:35:11] visually see the cohort 2022 which is the cohort for which this data will be available they were in their second year last year when schools closed in the spring, they are in their third or junior year this year as school divisions continually adapt to their COVID-19 response, and they will be seniors or in their fourth year next year, and the CCRI will be calculated at the conclusion of that year.

[00:35:44] And so that was all of the slides that we had, and Julie and I are happy to take any questions. Thank you, Dr. Paivarana and Ms. Malik. Again, we'll just pause for a second more to see if there's any additional questions from either committee members or board members. Dr. Paxton, I have a question. Dr. Paivarana and Dr. Malik, thank you all very much for the presentation.

[00:36:21] Always appreciate visuals. Very helpful, very helpful. So, Dr. Paivarana, your last comment, the observation or the acknowledgement that we have the the lack of data that we have after waiving accreditation for this group of students have has the department given any consideration to um i won't say maybe a resolution or a suggestion for how it for for for how we might

[00:36:54] anticipate gleaning any information certainly will be incomplete but is there any pathway forward to trying to ascertain students or schools, I should say, achievement around this particular indicator.

[00:37:12] And then the other question that I have, which is much more hopeful, I guess, is knowing that an individual student may achieve or may reach multiple wrongs or multiple rings, but we don't give credit for that necessarily.

[00:37:28] I understand that what we're trying to do is to ensure perhaps a baseline, but thinking about that student who, and the school that provides multiple opportunities for students and students who take advantage of those, it just seems like a lost opportunity to acknowledge that in some way.

[00:37:49] - So we do provide divisions, student level information that describes if students have met any of the four components.

[00:38:05] so um but we don't aggregate them or produce them in that level so they could approximate and and evaluate the student level data um all along the way but we don't have any uh official definitive percent percents moving forward um as for the additional indicators i'm going to um defer to Dr. Piper-Renna, but I think we have to also consider school's ability to offer various

[00:38:42] components and we don't want to, you know, cause any school to have an advantage or disadvantage if they offer one component and perhaps not another. For sure, certainly we don't want to set up a situation where it becomes a race or, you know what I mean, but I guess my point is in instances where students are taking advantage of those. Is there a way to acknowledge in some way? So Ms. Malik, I absolutely get it and don't disagree with you that that is a caution that we

[00:39:16] should have, so for sure. And I'll just add that I think you're framing Dr. Wilson is correct, that this metric is framed somewhat as a baseline. And we have attempted metrics in the past where we had more of an opportunity for students to get multiple you know to sort of receive acknowledgement for multiple indicators and it did create sort of this unintended consequence that julie mentioned i think there is some middle ground where we might be able to do kind of both because we certainly from a data perspective at least we certainly know

[00:39:53] which students are hitting each or multiple of the indicators so from a data perspective we're not limited in that i think it's um just making sure that we've sort of thought about that in terms of the unintended consequences and making sure that we're not creating sort of a ranking or a rating or anything like that and i suppose if it's if it is a matter of providing the information to divisions and then divisions may be in a position to acknowledge students for those kinds of things so thank you very much great any other questions dr pexton i have you

[00:40:31] yes dr dron thank you thank you dr malik and dr pan rivera for your presentation i am concerned and have a question about um this year as we all know with the virtual remote learning that's taking place for many of our students in my view at least three of the four components are really difficult to even have this year the first one obviously the opportunity to participate in advanced coursework and get credit that's something that can occur remotely the opportunity to engage in service learning, work-based learning, and complete CTE with the credential when many of our CTE courses are very challenging to do remotely and get the full

[00:41:09] credential. Some are, but there are others that are very challenging. So I would love to hear your thoughts and considerations that you've been having with regards to how we might provide flexibility or some other means to help address school divisions and students who during this school year that we're currently in may not be able to meet in my view three of the four components that's i think that's a an issue that's on all of our minds um i think we have to we are traveling

[00:41:44] through 2020 2021 as best we can with opportunities the best we can um michael bowling is here with instruction he may able to offer some insight on some feedback he's been receiving about the ability to reach those components. Michael would you mind popping in and if you if you have any thoughts? Yeah we have been receiving some feedback that you know they are struggling with meeting some of these requirements and we're working with them and talking with the possibility talking about possible waivers actually especially in the areas of work-based learning

[00:42:22] because students are not able to register hours and so they're really struggling with meeting those requirements okay thank you um and chair paxton i guess something i would love for us to consider consider to think about as we move forward with our final work on what kind of flexibility we are going to make sure is available in this case i think that for school divisions and students through no fault of their own to the current conditions that we're in for the pandemic i don't want schools to be school divisions to be affected negatively in accreditation when in my view in many school divisions three of the four are impossible to to very challenging to

[00:43:02] do so uh part of i know our charge as a committee uh chair pexton is to think about what are those barriers and and that might be in place and i think this is a huge one for us to consider so thank you um dr malik and michael for your your comments i'm glad you're thinking about it but i just want to make sure we have something formal that we can be sure that we put in place thank - Thank you, Chair Paxton, that's all I have.

[00:43:29] - Yeah, Dr. Durand, I certainly agree with that position and this is just a very good case in point example of why I think our committee work is timely. You know, we didn't necessarily decide to launch this committee as a result of a pandemic.

[00:43:45] We actually decided to before, might've been a little delayed, but I think this is a good example of the impact that the 2017 SOA accreditation changes have a adversity on some of our school populations if we don't consider some flexibility when this particular criteria goes in place any other questions okay well thank you very much dr malik dr pivarena appreciate your presentation and providing that information to us all right

[00:44:21] we're going to move on to our second presentation which is going to be the update on growth measures used in school accreditation calculations um the use of student growth measures has been a topic of interest uh to the board for quite some time and we've received updates from excuse me shelley loving writer assistant superintendent of student assessment accountability in esea programs in the past and we are pleased to receive another update from her today good afternoon dr pexton and members of the committee um i am having some connectivity issues so i am on the phone um can you all hear me

[00:45:00] okay yes we can thank you at some point I began to fade out if you all will just let me know I will try to adjust so this afternoon I am with you to provide you an update on how we measure growth in school accreditation and Julie if you'll go to the the first slide I think we'll begin there this is just context on how we use growth currently in accreditation and I know you've seen this this graphic many, many times, but it is a very important display of how the 2017 revision to

[00:45:39] the SOA really changed the way we look at school accreditation. And this graphic really represents what we call the combined rate. And one of the primary complaints about the old accreditation system was that it focused primarily on pass rates for students taking the SOL test.

[00:46:01] There was a great deal of concern that we were doing nothing to recognize the efforts of schools in working with students who perhaps didn't pass the SOL test, but made considerable growth within a year.

[00:46:18] So this combined rate really is an effort to acknowledge that work. And just as a reminder, it recognizes, of course, pass rates on reading and mathematics, but it also recognizes students who don't pass those reading or mathematics tests, but who make sufficient growth.

[00:46:44] And the students who show sufficient growth count just as much as a passing student. So we really are providing equal weight. And then lastly, we wanted to make sure that we were also acknowledging the work that our schools do with English learners who are still learning English.

[00:47:09] So for our reading assessment, for English learners who don't pass the reading SOL test, don't show sufficient growth, but do show progress in learning English as measured by the Access for ELLs assessment also counts.

[00:47:25] So just to go through the chart one more time, in our old accreditation system, we have six students in green here who passed. And so, in the old accreditation system, the rate used for this school would have been 60%.

[00:47:42] But with the use of the combined rate, we have an additional student who doesn't pass the reading assessment, but who shows growth. So there's an additional student who is counted there. And then one more student who is an English learner and has shown progress in learning English as measured by the access for ELLs.

[00:48:04] So under the new accreditation system, the combined rate that would be used for this school is 80%. So what I'm going to do for most of the rest of this presentation is to talk about how we measure growth for students who do not pass the SOL test in reading and mathematics, but do show growth.

[00:48:29] So what we are using right now are called the progress tables. And Julie, if you go to the next slide. And the progress tables, these really are an interim measure of measuring growth.

[00:48:45] We never intended them to be the way that we would measure growth forever. But it is an acceptable way of measuring growth and it is something that we could do with our SOL test the way they currently were.

[00:49:04] The next slide shows the scales on the SOL test And as they are currently configured, there is a separate scale for each SOL test. They go from zero to 600, and you'll see that there is a separate scale.

[00:49:20] In the progress tables, we are comparing students' scores from one year to the next. So we would compare a student's grade three reading score, for example, say in spring of 2018, to that student's grade four reading score in spring of 2019.

[00:49:43] Julie, if you will move to the next slide. And the way we measure this is by looking at how many levels students have moved. And this is just an example of how this works. You will remember from our discussion about setting cut scores for the SL reading test in November, that in Virginia we have four achievement levels for reading across the top, below basic, basic, proficient and advanced.

[00:50:14] And so for the progress tables, we wanted to make sure that we created as much opportunity for growth as possible. So we took those four performance levels or achievement levels and divided them in two. So instead of having four performance levels, now we have eight.

[00:50:34] So below basic becomes low below basic and high below basic. And the next slide shows how this works. So what we do is we look at a student's score from one year to the next.

[00:50:50] So we'll just pretend here that we had a student who scored high below basic on the grade three reading test. And then the next year that student moved to low basic as a fourth grader in reading.

[00:51:06] And so that student would have moved one sub-level and therefore would be considered to have made growth. So that really is how our current system works. I did want to acknowledge that the reading example I showed you is based on the old reading tests, not the ones that you just set the cut scores on.

[00:51:26] So Julie, if you'll go to the next slide. So as I mentioned before, the use of the progress tables was intended to be an interim measure while we worked on moving to what's called a vertical scale, which provides a more nuanced measure of growth for students.

[00:51:47] And Julie, if you'll go to the next slide. You all remember that we showed you earlier the example of the individual scales for each test. In a vertical scale, there actually is a scale that goes across the test.

[00:52:04] So you'll see here that now we have a vertical scale that goes across the test from grade three to grade eight, and it allows the reporting of growth along that scale. Now, in order to do this, we do have to do what are called vertical scaling studies.

[00:52:23] Julie, if you can go to the next slide. So we certainly acknowledge that our standards themselves, our standards of learning, are vertically aligned so that the content for grade four math, for example, builds on the content for grade three.

[00:52:39] But we also had to conduct some statistical studies to make sure that we could create this vertical scale. And as is the case with almost everything with testing, everything takes a long time. So you'll see that we've been working on this for a while.

[00:52:56] So we conducted a study in spring of '16 to link the content statistically of the reading test for grades three through eight and the math test for grades three through algebra one together so that a vertical scale could be created.

[00:53:12] And of course, in 2016, you also adopted new mathematics standards and they did change a bit. So we did have to conduct another study in spring of 2018 to address the changes in the math content.

[00:53:27] Fortunately, the changes in the reading standards of learning were not great enough that we had to do another linking study. So we were able to create the vertical scale using the existing study.

[00:53:44] But Julie, if you'll go to the next slide. So our original timeline for the vertical scale in math was really to begin that process in 2018-19. As you'll remember, that's the first year that we administered the new math test based on the standards you adopted in 2016.

[00:54:07] So 2018-19 would have been our baseline year for the use of the vertical scale. and then we would have used the results from 2019-20 to determine growth, and we would have used that for the 2020-2021 accreditation rating.

[00:54:26] Of course, as we well know, we did not test in the spring of '20, and accreditation was waived for 2021. Julie, if you'll go to the next slide. And then our timeline for reading was similar, except that the reading tests were a year behind.

[00:54:45] So as you all remember from November, we were supposed to administer our new reading test in spring of '20, and the vertical scale would have been available for the first time. And then we would have compared those results to the scores in 2021 to measure growth for the 2021-2022 accreditation rating. Next slide, Julie. Of course, COVID impacted all of this. So we did not test in

[00:55:16] spring of '20 and accreditation has been waived for 2020-2021 and 2021-2022. So what are our plans at this point? Julie, next slide. So our plan at this point is to use the scores in 2020-2021 as a baseline and then we'll use the scores from 2021-2022 to help us determine growth. I think it's important that we acknowledge the potential for continuing impacts on COVID-19, but not to be

[00:55:56] Pollyanna. Perhaps it's a benefit that we are going to have to use 2020-2021 as a baseline. That will certainly allow us to take into account any impacts of COVID on what we would consider to be growth. Before I take questions, I just wanted to acknowledge that What we have been using is a growth measure that looks at year from year to year growth.

[00:56:26] There are other types of growth. I know one of the questions that Ms. Holton has asked a number of times is how do we measure growth for grade three since we don't have any prior year score to use. It is possible to do a within year growth instead.

[00:56:48] that would require assessing at the beginning of the year and also the end of the year. So for grade three, we would administer a test in the fall of grade three and again in the spring of grade three. That's certainly a possibility. You know, when we have talked about that before, I think the concern has been about the additional testing. But I did want to acknowledge that while we have been looking at year-to-year growth within year growth is certainly a possibility.

[00:57:18] And Dr. Lane, I don't know if you had anything you wanted to add before we do questions. No, thanks, Shelley. Let me make sure I'm not muted. I'm not muted. Okay, great. No, I think you always do a great job of explaining this. Thank you. All right. So Dr. Paxton, if you have questions, I'd be happy to answer them. Dr. Paxton, you're on need yes i am i appreciate you uh keeping us up to date uh and uh providing this overview for us

[00:57:53] all right any questions from the committee or other board members dr paxton i have one question thanks so much um miss loving writer for the presentation it was each time i hear this it is getting more and more internalized from an understanding perspective it is a very complex um structure and i'm curious as you talked about moving from progression tables to the vertical

[00:58:23] um vertical linking that you describe how do you um i guess i i don't have in my mind how frequently um standards and tests are updated and the extent to which the lag associated with how that impacts the statistical work you described and i just wondered from your perspective if you if you think that there's something that's lost from a lag in terms of just the recency of being able to

[00:59:02] understand uh progress in a consistent way when there is this i don't know if i'm being articulate but it just seemed like the the change in test um and what that introduces in terms of your methodology creates some moments of different approaches being used to understand progress.

[00:59:30] That's what I'm wondering about. I think I understand your question clearly. So the standards of learning are reviewed every seven years. Yes. And then sometimes that review results in a fairly significant change. Sometimes the review results in fairly minor changes.

[00:59:55] And so an example here is with the adoption of the math standards in 2016, that was a fairly significant change, whereas reading was not as significant. We typically implement tests that measure those new standards three years after the adoption of the new and the reason for that is you know we use a very methodical approach to developing our standards I'm sorry the items so the items are developed and then they're

[01:00:32] reviewed by Virginia teachers to make sure that they measure and are appropriate for our students once they are reviewed the first time then they're they're field tested or tried out with our students without those questions counting towards the students score then those items are reviewed again by Virginia teachers before they go on to a test to count for students so it is a very deliberate process to make sure that our questions are appropriate for students I think Virginia is to be commended for the fact that we do have a

[01:01:11] regular review of our standards that's not the case in all states and so that we do that you all actually require a regular review um speaks to your commitment to making sure that what we expect our students to learn and be able to do is up to date so hopefully that that helped yes i just couldn't remember how often tests actually change you can't predict that because you don't know necessarily what revisions will happen if and if that will necessitate a change in testing and so i was just curious because it did seem like there was a protracted period of having to really do

[01:01:50] the work around getting the vertical studies done that you articulated for the more nuanced approach to understanding progress so thank you i should clarify reading again is a good example um those standards did change enough so that we created new tests but it didn't impact the vertical scale so there is that new okay thank you dr pexton may i yes by all means thank you um uh thank you uh

[01:02:25] shelly as usual for hard work and and great explanation uh just the the pandemic just makes a mess of these multi-year things and and i appreciate you all's hard work to try to figure out the adjustments two questions on the pandemic related adjustments one is have we thought about using some kind of skip year growth measure so you know trying to measure growth what what would the 2018-2019 data look like compared to if we aren't and this may be particularly relevant if leading

[01:03:00] to my second question if we're not able to gather data this spring which is certainly a question mark we'll all we'll all see how the spring progresses and and related to that i wondered if we've thought and this may be getting beyond your presentation it may get to things we'll want to talk about with dr lane tomorrow or in march but if if it gets to be harder and harder to less and less likely that we're going to be able to administer tests this spring is there any contemplation about administering what would normally have been the spring

[01:03:37] administration in the fall so not switching on a systemic basis to a fall spring uh growth kind of measure but for in risk i personally am more optimistic that we'll be able to administer our tests uh in a fairly normal fashion if we chose to do so by september than in may or april and may for some jurisdictions so um jerry might i jump in on that first you want me to so uh uh

[01:04:11] thank you uh miss holton the uh it's important to note that uh in high schools a lot of high schools and a lot of middle schools they're on block schedules and assessments have already begun and so that the assessments that are typically in the spring you know we're we're nearing completion for potentially half of the students in many of our schools and we're hearing a lot of stories about other schools creating innovative ways to have students assessed. The new president's administration has basically indicated and of course the previous president's administration

[01:04:49] both indicated that waivers of these assessments were unlikely. The board already provided flexibility in the non-federally related tests. And so what we have done, and we actually announced this by memo last Friday, we have basically opened up the testing window for the remainder of the year to the end of June. And so with the exception of 10 days from March 5th to March 15th, where we're changing from

the fall semester to the spring semester testing season, students can be tested anytime. And so we're hearing a lot of stories of schools that are not as in-person as others right the schools that are in person don't have quite the same barriers but maybe they're

[01:05:29] bringing kids in you know one kid per room and you know 20 kids a day or in two shifts 40 kids a day and and because of the the ability that that Pearson has allowed us to flex that window we actually believe uh there there shouldn't be major barriers to delivering the assessment now on the flip side of that you can't expect some parent opt-outs to be higher than in past years and in those cases we may struggle to have a growth metric on the individual student basis but uh we still you know we probably won't hit you know 98 99 of testing like we would in in a normal year uh or

[01:06:07] even 95 but i do think that we'll have uh you know a strong showing as it relates to uh the number of students that are assessed especially as we start to uh vaccinate uh more and more teachers more and more school divisions are likely going to be opening in person and and these assessments will occur in those those areas and so again it's one of the reasons we waived accreditation because i don't know that this year's school should be held accountable but this ability to collect data and see how students are doing and then to use that for the baseline for the future we felt like it

[01:06:42] was an important move for us in virginia thank you very helpful and as so i understand you think you're going to get realistically you think you're going to get not as much test data as you normally would but enough to make uh to be valid and useful for growth purposes well for every student that takes it in in grades three through seven we will be able to measure growth on that student in grades

[01:07:11] four through eight okay great any other questions from committee or board members or miss loving writer all right um so i actually am going to uh turn over the introduction of the third presentation to dr wilson i have an unexpected situation that i need to address uh so dr wilson has graciously

[01:07:44] agreed to step in so dr wilson i'll let you take the floor from here thank you dr pexton um so that brings us on our agenda to the final presentation we have prepared defining and supporting students with limited and or interrupted formal education. Certainly this is a topic that we have been discussing quite frequently over the last several months and we have been awaiting eagerly this presentation for this committee. So Dr. Leslie Sale again Director of Policy and Dr.

[01:08:17] Jessica Costa Specialist for English Learning Instruction will walk us through this presentation where we anticipate they will provide an overview of SLIFE, review the proposed common statewide definition of SLIFE, and data collection process, discuss the potential impact on accreditation, and the course charted for next steps. Leslie and Jessica, I'll turn the screen now over to you.

[01:08:43] Thank you all so much in advance for your preparation for this. Well, thank you so much, Dr. Wilson, and to the rest of the committee members and the board members joining us this afternoon um we appreciate you giving us some of your agenda time um and um hopefully we we live up to the hype here since you guys have been waiting the presentation um as a short preface um i do want to start by sharing a little bit more about the impetus for the work um and dr wilson i think you you have already captured it well um but this is what informed today's presentation um of course

[01:09:21] is your continued interest in better understanding our students with limited and or interrupted formal education and how they're represented in our accreditation model so of course we wanted to be responsive to that request and additionally as you all all may already know this work is actually also the in

part the result of legislation from the 2021 general assembly session which tasks both the department and the board with identifying slave students in virginia and how they are served so we'll talk a little bit more about that legislation in the slides to come but just again a short overview of how we landed at this presentation today

[01:10:00] and then where we go with this presentation and again Dr. Wilson I think you hit the highlights of what we'll be covering but I will start off with providing just a short high level overview of students with limited and or interrupted formal education and the importance of this endeavor as we better understand the subset of students I will note for those folks who are steeped in the literature and research we are going to use the acronym SLIFE moving forward so again those are our students with limited and or formal interrupted education whereas some of folks might be also familiar with acronym SIFE which just captures those students with interrupted

[01:10:38] formal education and we felt like the acronym that we're using with SLIFE captures students with educational backgrounds that were limited interrupted or both so if you hear us just use the term SLIFE that was the logic behind that decision. To help me with the next three bullets that we have on the screen I am joined today by Dr. Jessica Costa who is our English learner instructional specialist who's going to walk you through the proposed statewide definition of SLIFE and of course how we got there and she's also going to discuss the new data collection process and touch on some of the existing state-level initiatives and supports from SLIFE and from

[01:11:18] there i will close us out with a short synopsis of how this work might contribute to the committee's discussion on accreditation and help chart our course forward so emily next slide please so who are our slife students um speaking generally slife are typically non-native english speakers which means that this group of students are often considered a subset of our english learner student population or ELs but however beyond this there's very little else we can definitively say is common to the student population SLIFE are a highly diverse group of students each with a unique

[01:11:57] educational background and circumstance um and below you'll see a number of variables that that may vary from student to student um and these students may vary in the type or frequency of schooling they were exposed to in their countries of origin the nature of their relocations and and associated trauma or how they've been impacted by a number of other economic or environmental factors.

[01:12:22] Next slide, Emily. So you might be asking yourself if we already have kind of this rough and general sense of who these students are. And then of course, then we recognize how highly variable these students are. Why kind of take on this task of defining SLIFE?

[01:12:41] I will start with saying, practically speaking, having a focused operational definition of SLIFE, Of course, will help us facilitate the data collection process and truly understand trends and our student demographic across the Commonwealth. And we think this is particularly important in the Commonwealth, because if we infer from the growing numbers of EL in the state.

[01:13:01] We can expect that the student population of life is also increasing as well, but even more importantly, it is critical to find and understand these students beyond just their EL status because the students often face more complex and variant challenges than those typically encountered by other EL students. And of those variables we noted in the past slide, each of those making each SLIFE student unique, and of course that's not even an exhaustive list, each have the potential to impact a student's

academic and social-emotional growth and success. So as you will see in a few of the bullets on this slide, research has affirmed this relationship between SLIFE and academic outcomes.

[01:13:41] So two of the notable statistics we had found in doing some of our research, an estimated 20% of ELs in high school and 12 percent of ELs in middle school had missed two or more years of schooling so which does constitute that limited and or and or interrupted formal education criteria and this underschooled group of students was found to be most at risk for academic failure the dropout rate for teens with school problems before migration is in excess of 70 percent as compared with eight percent for other foreign-born youths so even these high-level trends which are not necessarily specific to our Virginia demographic, we think still demonstrate the need and value

[01:14:20] of understanding who these students are and their experiences, and of course how that's translating to student outcomes. So with that, I am going to turn it over to Dr. Costa to share a little bit more about the process and key considerations that went into the development of the Common and Statewide Definition of SLIFE, and then I will circle back with you guys once she's completed.

[01:14:39] Thank you so much, and I echo my colleagues' appreciation for being able to present to you this afternoon. Again, my name is Dr. Jessica Costa. I'm the English Learner Instruction Specialist at the Virginia Department of Education. I actually work within the Department of Learning and Innovation and the Office of Humanities.

[01:15:02] And my presentation is going to focus on three things today. The process for how we define SLIFE and the research that was involved in that, the actual proposed definition, and then some additional details about each of the components of the definition and how we derive them.

[01:15:21] So as you're well aware defining slice began with Senate Bill 933 during the 2020 regular session of the General Assembly. And as you'll recall, the bill directed the VDOE to develop and adopt a common statewide definition to then evaluate local programs for the supports and programs available for those students or supports and services.

[01:15:44] So the VDOE began the process of developing the definition by convening a committee of various stakeholders and this committee was inclusive of both regional representation and roles within the divisions to collaborate towards the development of the statewide definition.

[01:16:01] The team included a number of directors, including directors of instruction, chief academic officers, directors of federal programs, including ESOL programs, and teachers. The draft was revised multiple times based on the input from both stakeholders who've been part of the initial discussion, as well as others who could provide additional perspective throughout the course of development.

[01:16:29] VDOE staff led discussions and feedback loops through guiding questions that centered on the student and the student experience. You can see a few of those on the screen. You'll also notice that the team considered how other states define SLIFE. So here the definition before you reflects the work of the committee and the recommendations of VDOE senior leadership. I'm going to take each component and give additional background. Freshhold of the age of eight reflects a discussion of how

[01:17:07] some of the students may not start school in certain countries until after the age of six. So by age eight we would have a sense of whether these students have two years less schooling. And to be equitable, the team wanted to identify and support life as soon as possible. Having the data at this age may also provide some additional insight to divisions as they do some analysis of third grade reading

benchmark data. A focus on English language proficiency levels one and two allows divisions to target the students in the most need of support to access the grade level

[01:17:44] content. A student is no longer considered an EL once they earn a score of 4.4 on the access for ELL's annual assessment we heard a little bit about earlier in the presentation or this afternoon's meeting. Therefore, levels three and four are closer to proficiency and may not need the extent of specialized instruction as those students were still beginning in emerging levels of English proficiency. The two years less schooling aligned with examples from other states and is a common understanding of the definition in the literature and in the field. The committee

[01:18:22] considered using English literacy and numeracy proficiency measures to determine how behind a student is compared to their peers, but this cannot always be consistently applied based on different course pathways, availability of certain types of assessments, and so forth.

[01:18:40] Two years is a significant amount of lost time and creates a pointed challenge in getting those students caught up. Similar aged peers is used since there are cases in which divisions may not have accurate information to make a grade level comparison. As you may remember, Senate Bill 933 also tasked the VDOE with requiring local school divisions to report the number of students who fall under such a such a definition as part of the required data collection and reporting

[01:19:16] to support this effort members of multiple departments within the video collaborated to proactively draft a companion guide for technical assistance for divisions to comply with the senate bill the resource is in develop is in the development stages as the video awaits approval of the slight definition in conversations with colleagues and special education we are leaning on current guidance for ELs with dual identifications for coordinating multiple services required by the U.S. Department of Education, Department of Justice, and Department of Civil

[01:19:50] Rights. The VDOE recognized the unique circumstances for SLIFE and the English learner population at large prior to this legislation. The VDOE has taken initiative on behalf of the board to support the requirement to learn more about who the SLIFE are and working to understand the supports and services that create the educational experience for these students at the division level.

[01:20:22] Within the last two years, VDOE created new codes to track division's language instruction educational programming provided to ELs and created an English learner instruction specialist position within the Department of Learning and Innovation. On the screen you can also see a number of additional initiatives and supports at the state level to provide support for divisions as they serve English learners including SLIFE. Additional support hinges on the approval and state rollout of the SLIFE definition. VDOE will provide additional support to teachers and administrators

[01:21:00] for identifying and supporting SLIFE, including considerations for staff, training for communicating with families, and implementing consistent data collection and reporting methods. Supports will also be available related to providing programs and services that accelerate SLIFE access to rigorous grade level content within inclusive classrooms. Our professional learning is provided by VDOE, which infuses ideas for how to support SLIFE instructionally. And then with that,

[01:21:32] I'm going to hand it back over to my colleague to dig into more information about the connections to accreditation. Thank you. Thank you, Dr. Costa. So as Dr. Costa explained the definition of SLIFE, and of course the next steps that we're taking in terms of data collection um the next kind of logical

big question for us is once we have the data what do we do with it um and so on this slide um part of our answer comes from that senate bill 933 from the 2020 general assembly session

[01:22:09] so i wanted to start by quickly revisiting the mandate of the senate bill 933 and so one of the key purposes of collecting this data is to evaluate accreditation based on what we learn about the the student demographic. I will note that, of course, as we've discussed in previous presentations this morning or this afternoon, rather, this legislation was contemplated prior to the pandemic. And since then, there have been a number of other reasons to revisit accreditation for the 2021-2022 school year. And as you all know, accreditation for the 2021-2022 school year,

[01:22:46] which is based on this school year's data has been waived. So this will of course necessarily have an impact on the timeline of how we operationalize and put into to kind of affect the data that we get from this life data collection process.

[01:23:03] But we are keeping the patron of this bill abreast of our work and are still plugging ahead, trying to be as cognizant about the timeline so we can effectuate this data and put it to good use as soon as possible. So next slide, Emily.

[01:23:21] So still building on the question of what do we do with the data once we have it? I thought this table might also help the question at hand. This shows the graduation, completion, and dropout rates for ELs based on four-year cohort data for the last five years.

[01:23:39] And this is just available from our Build-A-Table on the website. And what is less important here for us, I think is what these numbers tell us. And more important is what these numbers do not tell us and the potential of the data we seek to collect to fill in those gaps.

[01:23:55] So as you look at this data right now, we don't know which of these students are SLIFE students, when they entered the Virginia public school system and what supports they received during their time in the Virginia public school system. So you can imagine if we have that supporting SLIFE data, we'll really start to give insight to these numbers and how we might operationalize this information.

[01:24:17] But as I noted from the past slide, this data will also be an important tool for us as we understand how these students are considered in our current accreditation model per that mandate in Senate Bill 933. Next slide, Emily.

[01:24:33] So thinking about how this information might intersect with our current accreditation model, I thought I would share some of the indicators we felt are most likely to be implicated by the data. So as you guys well know, the recent changes to the accreditation model that allow for growth does help to ensure that we are seeing SLIFE student progress, especially in those earlier grades.

[01:24:53] And this is reflected in our achievement and achievement gap indicators and accreditation. So SLIFE are already being considered in the new accreditation model. But of course, there are other opportunities to think about those points of intersection.

[01:25:10] But however, I think what we've heard from divisions is that the most pointed concerns for SLIFE are those who enter into Virginia public school system late and the risk of academic failure and dropping out are even more imminent since they're joining us in the later years and this is compounded by the fact that our teachers and divisions are having less time with these students for remediation.

[01:25:32] So one of those indicators that we think that there might be a point of intersection here are one of the student engagement indicators which is the graduation and completion index. So I will say this slide probably looks fairly familiar to you all since it was pulled from an earlier presentation when the committee took a deeper look at the individual accreditation indicators and we looked at how each are calculated and you'll see here the sample calculation model and so this of course you can probably deduce here how we might anticipate late entries life

[01:26:06] students having an impact on this particular indicator next slide emily a second point of intersection for these late entry students may be the dropout rate so again this slide was pulled from an earlier presentation and just a reminder of how our dropout rates are calculated and so if you look at all of those bullet points here that enumerates what dropout students who dropout students are not so if they fall outside of those categories they are considered a dropout student

[01:26:39] and again we might see how our late entries life students might be impacted by the dropout rate or rather vice versa, how SLIFE students impact the dropout rate. So identifying these indicators is of course right now speculative for us until we have a better sense of the SLIFE demographic that will come with the data collection process. It is difficult to speak concretely about how exactly we might reconsider any accreditation indicators, but again these are ones of note for us that we've heard anecdotally and from divisions might have a pretty significant interplay with SLIFE students,

[01:27:17] especially as they're joining the public school system um later in their high school careers next slide emily so next steps for us um while a lot of work has already been done there are still several items on our to-do list um so looking forward we expect to use the next few months to tackle the following of course we're going to begin the data collection process here shortly with local school divisions and as part of that iterative process as we collect data we'll also be able to start to evaluate and analyze how the definition and collection process

[01:27:52] itself is going so we want to be responsive to the the type and quality and validity of data we're receiving during that initial data collection process of course once we do have the the data in-house we'll begin analyzing and taking a look at trends and demographics there and of course we'll we'll use that information to evaluate opportunities for getting a more nuanced picture of life especially as it may inform some targeted supports for these students and as you guys can anticipate once we have that data collection are able to synthesize and better understand what it might mean for accreditation we anticipate of returning to you all with some

[01:28:31] recommendations to the SOA work group on potential changes to the accreditation if merited by the data so with that I think Dr. Acosta and I are both prepared to take any questions you might have and I know we have others on the call well who are steeped in the accreditation model and the instructional component so we may also find friends on the call as well but happy to take any questions you all have always good to have lifelines that you can call on right that team approach thank you both so much for that presentation I'll pause here and see if there are any questions from committee members or board members Dr. Duran thank you

[01:29:11] well first and foremost thank you thank you thank you thank you I'm so thrilled and excited to hear all this presentation. It's a breath of fresh air. I'm very, very happy that we are talking about this at the state level. There are not all states are talking about this across the country, and we should commend ourselves, and I want to thank you and all the individuals who've been involved in this work for having this

conversation. And yes, while there were Senate bills and General Assembly action to get us to move here, I know that prior to that, you know, Dr. Acosta you had spoke to us about this well before the legislation and we've been talking

[01:29:48] about this at the state board is something we need to do so I'm glad very glad that the legislation was there but I know that it's a commitment of yours and Dr. Lane has you know at that time also in a retreat we had I remember very well that retreat we had in Chesterfield where we spoke about this very issue so I'm just I'm almost lost for words because I'm so happy about this but I just want to thank you for that a couple of comments I want to make and questions I guess. The first one, I just have three. The first one is really around the definition and the companion guide that will go along for data collection. I wanted to understand the notion of

[01:30:21] at least two years, if there will be any guidance in the companion guide to talk to, many of these live students do not actually come with records of their experience. So my question is, will there be guidance to school divisions that if a child does not have any records, they could be considered if they have those other two categories of over eight and the el level um elp level of one and two or what guidance will you provide to school divisions for students who have no records and actually don't ever get records i have experience as a principal working in central office with

[01:30:57] life students over many years and there's a large number who would never have a record for us so what would be that's my first question what would be the guidance and have you thought about that you probably have thought about i'm sure so i guess what is the guidance thank you for the question

[01:31:11] Yes, we have thought about that. We recognize that in the divisions, as you mentioned, a lot of students may come in without that documentation. So in that draft guidance document that we're working, a resource document, I'll call it companion document, we have outlined what some of the options are for divisions to collect that information, whether it's through a parent survey, we have developed a prototype for what that could be or some questions in parent friendly language that they could use to get information.

[01:31:41] about the student's experience. So we have outlined a number of options for divisions to work with the families, work with the students, sometimes working with liaisons, or if a student's coming in through our refugee resettlement program, working with one of the supports in that way.

[01:32:04] So a number of options for divisions to explore as they try to identify the students. - Thank you, I think that's very important as we know, we don't want those students who have more records, who may be students who really need the supports to not get the support when someone may literally think, well, it's two years or less and I don't know the number of years, so I'm not gonna count them in my data.

[01:32:29] I've actually heard that conversation before in other places, so I wanna make sure we're very intentional about telling school divisions here, the protocol you could use as you just described, or really a way to support who those students are. The second one is more for our colleagues.

[01:32:45] Once we get more information on the data after it's collected, I want to encourage all of us to think back about our SOQ recommendations for EL teachers. I do believe that SLIFE students should be in that factor in terms of another level of ratio that we recommend in the standards of quality.

[01:33:03] I do believe that the students who are SLIFE, and again, thank you for using SLIFE and not SAIF. I know it was a conscious decision that you talked about. But those students who are SLIFE really do

need individualized supports. As you indicated in your presentation, targeted supports.

[01:33:21] And those targeted supports look differently than even another English language learner who's at that same proficiency level. So I would encourage us when we get the data to have that conversation. And I know it's something we're having now because we don't have the data. The third point I want to make is when we talk about supporting our SLIFE students, you mentioned at the end targeted supports that will be very intentional to also indicate not just academic or instructional supports but mental health and wellness and counseling supports for many of these students who come to us without families at times without their own family

[01:33:56] they may be reunified with their family after being apart for some time and so we as we think about the targeted supports that were very specific but they're inclusive of not just academic and instructional. I'm sure you thought about that, but in the presentation, it references several times to instructional support, and rightfully so. I just want to make sure we balance that with the needs of what the student community needs, this particular group of students. So thank you again. I'm so thrilled. I look forward to, I think you hit it on the nail, Dr. Sal, in terms of those areas that we should look at for accreditation without having the data yet, but the ones you shared at the end of your presentation, I think are certainly ones of this

[01:34:36] committee needs to look at deeply when we have the data and i look forward to hearing your recommendations as a team about what those might be for us to consider our english learner students i believe an equity issue that we're all committed to as colleagues on the board is to make sure they're getting the individualized academic and non-academic supports they need to be successful and whatever we can do as a board to make that happen to have accountability for school divisions to make sure they're doing that is something that's long needed here in virginia but across the com across the country unfortunately we're leading this work because a lot of states are not

[01:35:14] even discussing this and don't want to discuss it so thank you dr lane thank you dr costa thank you dr sal for leading us in at the state level and saying this is important and we are going to move forward with this and we are going to look at how we're going to help school divisions be thoughtful of targeted supports, and we're also going to have accountability measures to ensure that our English learner students are not forgotten. So I am just thrilled and elated and very, very happy. This whole presentation, and having served on the ward for many years now, is one of the highlights of my presentations I've been in. So I don't just say that lightly,

[01:35:50] but thank you very much. Thank you, Dr. Duran. Other questions or comments? So I do have one question or perhaps suggestion. Following on one comment that Dr. Duran made as we look at the definition, the definition has three of what we are, how we are defining SLIFE in Virginia, three components and the word and is between each of them.

[01:36:20] And so that leads us to believe that all three of the components must be met in order for a child to be considered SLIFE. and that may be intentional, but based on the response just now to Dr. Duran's question about records, I wonder if there was any contemplation of or so that there is some flexibility or what that looks like.

[01:36:46] And it may not be a conversation for today, but just in thinking about the definition and if we truly are intending that all three of the components must be met in order for a student to be defined as life here in Virginia.

[01:37:02] At this time, that is how we conceptualized it and then providing the support so divisions would be able to collect that information just to be in alignment with what the other states do have there is that two year benchmark, so to speak, for the differences and so we did think that all three of those were important, but I think that's something we can bring back to the team, we can revisit.

[01:37:30] JoAnne Hanrahan: And even if it's not revisiting you know I don't question the process and I don't question the team's recommendation, I just wanted to make sure I was clear, but whatever the. JoAnne Hanrahan: Guidance or support documents that go along with, I think, Dr Costa you mentioned the alternatives, perhaps that or suggestions for other.

[01:37:49] JoAnne Hanrahan: documentation that may be useful, I think, having that may be very helpful as divisions are working through this. Dr. Wilson, if I might add to that real quick, the language of the companion document not only includes options, but it's very encouraging of supporting informal documentation and evidence that's provided through experiences and through things like we provide some samples on questions

[01:38:27] that could be asked in an interview setting so that it's less formal. We understand that, you know, some students are leaving war-torn countries, cannot get that documentation or civil strife or whatever the situation. But we do want, we're putting the emphasis on putting the default back on their evidence that they're providing is truthful in nature.

[01:38:49] Thank you. Yeah, and I would just, again, thank you for the question and Dr. Rohn, thank you for, you know continuing to make this a priority for us i i agree with the team and that we feel pretty strongly that meeting all three indicators is important but i think we can always have conversations about the business rules as it relates to how you qualify for any one of the three and and talk about flexibility there but uh when i look at what those three say uh you know it's really helping you understand that these are students who are you know closer to the end of

[01:39:25] their education career and have significant impacts. And we don't necessarily have the time that we would have with other potential EL students to make up the differential. So just my general thoughts. Thank you. Other comments or questions? Dr. Wilson. Ms. Davis-Wall. I would just like to say to Dr. Sale and to Dr. Costa, thank you very much for your thoughtful description. I'm following you and you helped clear up some things in my line of thinking. So thank you very much. I'm very

[01:39:57] appreciative of all the things you put together for this presentation it's very good all right thank you all again i don't see any other comments or hands raised so really appreciate your time and your efforts here and that along with the rest of your colleagues for the other presentations that we've heard today i will say as a committee member and board member i have been so appreciative of the responsiveness of the staff at doe and providing the information that we've asked for and the conversation and questions that my board colleagues have raised along the way.

[01:40:36] You all know that I am pinch hitting for Dr. Pexton and so I do not intend to put words in her mouth but I suspect quite fully that she will be following up with us as we prepare for our next meeting which is scheduled for March 17th. As you all know the board nor the committee will be meeting in February. The intention, as I understand it, is at that March meeting to review technical language changes and potential SOA compliance levers, as Dr. Pexton lined out at the beginning

[01:41:09] of her comments this afternoon. We are narrowing down, I suppose, our focus, having had a number of presentations over the last several months. So before we adjourn, are there any last questions or request that you'd like us to pass on to Dr. Pexton. Emily, I see you have unmuted. Does that mean that you have something to know? Okay. Well then, with that, I will adjourn this committee meeting and look forward to seeing everyone tomorrow morning in our full business meeting,

[01:41:43] which begins, I believe, at 10 o'clock with Mr. Decker calling us to order at that time. Have a great afternoon, everyone. Thank you, everyone. Thanks, everybody.

